

Moritz Seebacher

Contact Information

ifo Institute, Center for the Economics of Education
Poschingerstraße 5, 81679 Munich, Germany
seebacher@ifo.de | +49 89 9224 1327

Fields

Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Big Data Economics

Current Position

10/2022 – present	Junior Economist ifo Center for the Economics of Education
10/2022 – present	PhD Candidate in Economics LMU Munich Supervisor: Prof. Ludger Woessmann

Education

11/2020 – 09/2022	Master of Science in Economics University of Konstanz
10/2017 – 09/2020	Bachelor of Science in Economics University of Konstanz
09/2019 – 01/2020	Semester Abroad University of Valencia

Research Visits

09/2025 – 12/2025	Yale Department of Economics Host: Prof. Joseph Altonji
-------------------	---

Job Market Paper

Career Effects of Online Social Network Access at Labor Market Entry, 2026

Exploiting the staggered introduction of Facebook across U.S. colleges in a difference-in-differences design, I estimate the causal impact of online social network access at labor market entry on the career trajectories of business and economics students. Using data from nearly 900,000 public LinkedIn profiles, I find that students with early access to Facebook are more likely to receive early-career promotions, work in higher-paying jobs, and reach senior leadership roles in their mid-30s to early 40s. Investigating potential mechanisms, I provide evidence that these effects can be explained by (i) a more successful college-to-work transition, driven by college peers helping each other access higher-quality early-career jobs, (ii) more stable and productive worker-firm matches early on, enabling students to climb up the career ladder within their organizations, and (iii) intensified early-career sorting into higher-quality and career-supporting firms. The results highlight how access to online social networks during a sensitive period of a young worker's career can facilitate the college-to-work transition, reduce information frictions, and generate long-lasting career benefits.

Publications

Pathways to Progress: The Complementarity of Bicycles and Road Infrastructure for Girls' Education, *Economics of Education Review*, 97, 102483, 2023

In which settings can bicycles help to improve girls' education in low-income countries? This paper analyzes the complementarity between all-weather roads and a bicycle program in India aimed at increasing girls' secondary school enrollment. Using a triple-difference strategy, I find that the program benefits girls living 3–10 km away from schools with all-weather road connections, increasing their enrollment by 60 percent and reducing the gender enrollment gap by 51 percent. There are no effects for girls in villages without all-weather roads or girls living more than 10 km from school. The findings emphasize the importance and interdependence of road infrastructure, mode of transport, and distance to school for improving girls' education in India.

Working Papers

Multidimensional Skills on LinkedIn Profiles: Measuring Human Capital and the Gender Skill Gap (with David Dorn, Florian Schoner, Lisa Simon, and Ludger Woessmann), *IZA Discussion Paper* No. 17896, 2025

We measure human capital using the self-reported skill sets of nearly 9 million U.S. college graduates from professional profiles on LinkedIn. We aggregate skill strings into 48 clusters of general, occupation-specific, and managerial skills. Multidimensional skills can account for several important labor-market patterns. First, the number and composition of skills are systematically related to measures of human-capital investment such as education and work experience. The number of skills increases with experience, and the average age-skill profile closely resembles the well-established concave age-earnings profile. Second, workers who report more skills, especially specific and managerial ones, hold higher-paid jobs. Skill differences account for more earnings variation than detailed measures of education and experience. Third, we document a sizable gender gap in skills. While women and men report nearly equal numbers of skills shortly after college graduation, women's skill count increases more slowly with age subsequently. A simple quantitative exercise shows that women's slower skill accumulation can be fully accounted for by reduced work hours associated with motherhood. The resulting gender differences in skills rationalize a substantial proportion of the gender gap in job-based earnings.

Work in Progress

Alumni Networks, First Job Placements, and the College Selectivity Premium (with Căcilia vom Baur, Katia Werkmeister, and Ludger Woessmann)

How important are college alumni networks for graduates' first job placement and earnings differences across colleges? Using detailed resume data from the universe of public LinkedIn profiles, we show that graduates of selective four-year U.S. colleges disproportionately start their careers at alumni-connected firms, more than location and sector preferences predict. Alumni networks also differ sharply in quality: alumni from elite colleges are 70 percent more likely to work at high-paying firms and 26 percent more likely to hold management positions than those from the least selective colleges. To examine the causal link between alumni and graduates' first job placements, we exploit plausibly exogenous variation in the timing of alumni firm-to-firm moves around graduates' job search. One additional alumnus at a firm before graduates complete their job search raises the probability that a graduate starts there by 13% relative to the baseline match probability. The effect is stronger for alumni in management and from the same major, as well as at less selective colleges. Yet, alumni draw more and less selective college graduates into different firms, affecting the college selectivity wage premium: Incorporating the causal estimates into a decomposition framework, we find that alumni networks account for at least 4% of the entry-level wage gap between elite and less-selective colleges. The results highlight that alumni networks play an important role in first job placement and serve as one mechanism behind the widely documented early-career earnings differences across colleges.

Policy Publications

Wie Fahrräder die Bildungschancen von Mädchen in Entwicklungsländern verbessern können, *ifo Schnelldienst*, 77(3), 33–38, 2024

Conferences, Workshops, and Invited Seminars

2026 (<i>scheduled</i>)	Colloquium on Personnel Economics (Rotterdam), EEA (Dublin), EALE (Barcelona), Verein für Socialpolitik (Innsbruck)
2025	Yale Department of Economics, MIT Sloan School of Management, IAB PhD Workshop (Nuremberg), CAREER Workshop (Amsterdam), Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting (Lindau)
2024	Verein für Socialpolitik (Berlin)
2023	International Workshop on Applied Economics of Education (Catanzaro), EALE (Prague), Verein für Socialpolitik (Regensburg)

Teaching Experience

Winter 2025/26	Centralized vs. Decentralized Education Systems: An Economic Perspective (Bachelor) Supervisor of bachelor thesis, LMU Munich
Summer 2025	Identifying Sheepskin Effects in the Returns to Education (Bachelor) Supervisor of bachelor thesis, LMU Munich
Winter 2023/24	Economics of Education (Bachelor) Teaching Assistant, LMU Munich
Winter 2023/24	Determinants of Effective Teacher Incentive Schemes (Bachelor) Supervisor of bachelor thesis, LMU Munich
Summer 2023	Worker Skills and the Digital Transformation of the Labor Market (Bachelor) Supervisor of term papers, LMU Munich
Summer 2019	Mathematics for Economists II (Bachelor) Teaching Assistant, University of Konstanz
Winter 2018/19	Mathematics for Economists I (Bachelor) Teaching Assistant, University of Konstanz

Awards and Scholarships

2025	DAAD Scholarship, research stay at Yale University
2022	VEUK Award for Academic Excellence, Master of Science in Economics
2020	VEUK Award for Academic Excellence, Bachelor of Science in Economics
2017 – 2022	Deutschlandstipendium, University of Konstanz

Refereeing

2025	<i>Economics of Education Review</i>
2023	<i>Economics of Education Review</i>

Research Experience

05/2022 – 09/2022	Student Research Assistant Politics of Inequality Cluster, University of Konstanz
-------------------	---

Outreach and Volunteering

03/2025 – 07/2025 **YES! – Young Economic Solutions**

03/2024 – 07/2024 Scientific advisor for student competition projects

05/2018 – 07/2024 **Private tutoring and student support**

Studenten bilden Schüler e.V., Tintenklecks e.V., Konstanz Buddy Program

Languages

German (native), English (proficient), Spanish (basic)

Technical Skills

R, SQL, LaTeX, Stata, Python, VS Code

Last updated: 6 September 2026